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UPSC

Answer Questions in NOT MORE THAN the Word Limit specified for each in the Parenthesis.
(Specimen Answer Booklet - For Practice Purpose Only)

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⑤ What were the key features of August offer 1940, and why was it rejected by both INC & Muslim League? (10m)
Following the outbreak of World War-II on 1st Sept. 1939, Congress ministries resigned on 23rd Oct. 1939 citing India's involvement without consultation from leadership. Coupled with fall of Belgium, France & Holland, Britain became conciliatory towards India which led to Viceroy Lilithgow to present August offer 1940.

Features of August offer

- ① Setting up of War Advisory Council with Britain retaining control over Defence, Finance and Home Affairs.
- ② Dominion status for India after war ends.
- ③ Recognition of India's right to frame their own Constitution.
- ④ No future Constitution will be framed without the consent of minorities.
- ⑤ Expansion of Viceroy's executive Council to have Indians in majority, drawn from major political parties.

Indian Response to August offer

- ① Congress - The INC rejected the August offer as a ignored INC's demand of complete independence.



Good contextual setup explaining how WWI and Britain's weakened position led to the August Offer. This historical background effectively frames the topic.

The War Advisory Council and Britain's retention of key portfolios should be presented as separate features. The Council was consultative while control over key departments related to the Executive Council.

b) Britain retained control over key areas - defence, finance and home affairs.

c) The minority clause allowed Muslim League to block any future constitutional progress.

d) The demand for dominion status was no longer viable as criticized by Nehru & Gandhi.

② Muslim League - Muslim League rejected the August offer as -

a) It lacked explicit provision for the future creation of Pakistan.

b) League demanded parity in viceroy executive council.

c) It welcomed the minority clause of offer.

Following the defeat of August offer, Britain passed a series of ordinances curtailing freedom of speech, press and peaceful protest which led to Mahatma Gandhi launching individual satyagraha on 17th October 1940 making Vinoba Bhave as 1st Satyagrahi & Jawaharlal Nehru as 2nd.

Coupled with the defeat of Cripps Mission (March 1942), it became a precipitating factor leading to the historic Quit India Movement on 8th August 1942.

Effective connection between August Offer's failure and subsequent movements. Shows good understanding of cause-effect relationships in the freedom struggle.

Well-analyzed reasons for Congress's rejection, covering both ideological differences and practical concerns about British control and the minority clause implications.

Good identification of League's primary concern about lack of Pakistan provision while acknowledging their support for the minority clause.

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- Sept. 1st 1939 - Germany attacks Poland.
- Sept. 3rd 1939 - Britain retaliates via attacking Germany
- Sept. 10-14th 1939 - CWC meeting @ Wardha passing a resolution on official stand of INC.
- Oct 1939 - White paper released by Lilithgow rejecting INC's demands.
- 23rd Oct 1939 - CWC meeting @ Wardha passed resolution directing resignation of Congress ministers.
- Dec 1939 - Deliverance day by Muslim League, increasing communal tensions.
- June 1940 - Fall of France in world war-II.
- August offer 1940 by Lord Lilithgow.
- INC & Muslim League rejecting August offer.
- 17th Oct 1940 - Individual CDM initiated by Gandhi, continued till 1941.
- Dec 1941 - Japanese invasion of Burma.
- March 1942 - Cripps Mission to India.
- Failure of Cripps Mission.
- Quit India Movement @ 8th August 1942, Gandhiji
Tank Maidan Bombay.



Comprehensive timeline
providing excellent
context for the August
Offer within the broader
freedom movement.

Good conclusion linking
the August Offer to
subsequent freedom
movements.